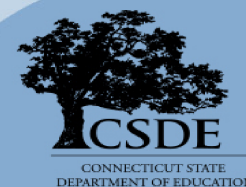


Connecticut State Department of Education

DISTRICT PROFILE AND PERFORMANCE REPORT FOR SCHOOL YEAR 2021–22



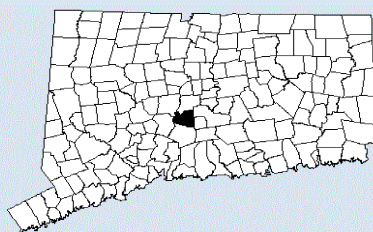
Meriden School District

Dr. Mark Benigni, Superintendent • 203-630-4171 • <http://www.meridenk12.org>

District Information

Grade Range	PK-12
Number of Schools/Programs	30
Enrollment	8,521
Per Pupil Expenditures ¹	\$15,160
Total Expenditures ¹	\$134,832,818

¹ Expenditure data reflect the 2020-21 school year.



Community Information

AdvanceCT Town Profiles provide summary demographic and economic information for Connecticut's municipalities at <https://www.advancect.org/site-selection/town-profiles>

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Notes

Unless otherwise noted, all data are for 2021-22 and include all grades offered by the district.

In most tables, data are displayed only for the three major race/ethnicity categories. For additional race/ethnicity categories, please visit <https://edsight.ct.gov>

State totals are not displayed as they are not comparable to district totals.

Special Education tables reflect only students for whom the district is fiscally responsible.

* When an asterisk is displayed, data have been suppressed to safeguard student confidentiality. Complete data suppression guidelines are available at <https://tinyurl.com/SuppressionPolicy>

N/A is displayed when a category is not applicable for a district or school.

Students

October 1, 2021 Enrollment²

	District		State
	Count	Percent of Total (%)	Percent of Total (%)
Female	*	*	48.5
Male	4,364	51.2	51.5
Non-Binary	*	*	0.1
American Indian or Alaska Native	*	*	0.3
Asian	174	2.0	5.1
Black or African American	938	11.0	12.6
Hispanic or Latino of any race	5,082	59.6	29.0
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	*	*	0.1
Two or More Races	351	4.1	4.3
White	1,963	23.0	48.6
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	1,454	17.1	8.8
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	6,439	75.6	40.6
Students with Disabilities ³	1,765	20.7	16.7

² This table represents students in grades PK-12 reported by the district in the Public School Information System (i.e., PSIS Reporting District).

³ Students in this category are students with an individualized education program (IEP) only. This category does not include students with Section 504 plans or services plans.

Chronic Absenteeism and Suspension/Expulsion

	Chronic Absenteeism ⁴		Suspension/Expulsion ⁵	
	Count	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Female	*	*	*	*
Male	1,267	29.8	543	11.7
Non-Binary	*	*	*	*
Black or African American	288	30.4	151	14.8
Hispanic or Latino of any race	1,627	32.7	575	10.7
White	417	21.7	137	6.6
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	472	32.2	136	8.7
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	2,175	33.2	802	11.4
Students with Disabilities	664	39.3	318	15.4
District	2,443	29.1	898	9.9
State		23.7		6.5

Number of students qualified as truant under state statute: 3,031

Number of school-based arrests: 12

⁴ A student is chronically absent if they miss ten percent or greater of the total number of days enrolled in the school year for any reason. Pre-Kindergarten students are excluded from this calculation.

⁵ This column displays the count and percentage of students who receive at least one in-school suspension, out-of-school suspension or expulsion.

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2021-22

Meriden School District

Educators

Full-Time Equivalent (FTE)¹ Staff

	FTE
General Education	
Teachers and Instructors	489.6
Paraprofessional Instructional Assistants	39.0
Special Education	
Teachers and Instructors	97.1
Paraprofessional Instructional Assistants	145.0
Administrators, Coordinators and Department Chairs	
District Central Office	14.5
School Level	36.6
Library/Media	
Specialists (Certified)	3.5
Support Staff	0.0
Instructional Specialists Who Support Teachers	36.4
Counselors, Social Workers and School Psychologists	57.3
School Nurses	15.0
Other Staff Providing Non-Instructional Services/Support	472.0

¹ In the full-time equivalent count, staff members working part-time in the school are counted as a fraction of full-time. For example, a teacher who works half-time in a school contributes 0.50 to the school's staff count.

Educators by Race/Ethnicity

	Count	District Percent of Total (%)	State Percent of Total (%)
American Indian or Alaska Native	4	0.5	0.1
Asian	4	0.5	1.3
Black or African American	20	2.7	4.3
Hispanic or Latino of any race	56	7.6	4.6
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	4	0.5	0.1
Two or More Races	0	0.0	0.2
White	649	88.1	89.2

Classroom Teacher Attendance: 2020-21

	District	State
Average Number of FTE Days Absent Due to Illness or Personal Time	9.7	10.4

Instruction and Resources

11th and 12th Graders Enrolled in College-and-Career-Readiness Courses during High School²

	11th		12th	
	Count	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Black or African American	56	72.7	73	90.1
Hispanic or Latino of any race	265	80.3	329	91.9
White	132	91.7	155	94.5
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	42	57.5	69	86.3
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	360	82.4	467	93.4
Students with Disabilities	86	77.5	155	90.1
District	486	82.8	595	92.5
State		81.7		87.7

² College-and-Career-Readiness Courses include Advanced Placement®(AP), International Baccalaureate®(IB), Career and Technical Education(CTE), workplace experience and dual credit courses.

Students with Disabilities Who Spend 79.1 to 100 Percent of Time with Nondisabled Peers³

	Count	Rate (%)
Autism	110	50.7
Emotional Disturbance	70	38.0
Intellectual Disability	35	34.0
Learning Disability	526	89.3
Other Health Impairment	241	71.1
Other Disabilities	13	20.6
Speech/Language Impairment	132	95.7
District	1,127	69.0
State		68.4

³ This table represents students ages 6-21 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2021-22

Meriden School District

Students with Disabilities by Primary Disability¹

	District		State
	Count	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Autism	240	2.7	2.3
Emotional Disturbance	185	2.1	1.1
Intellectual Disability	103	1.2	0.6
Learning Disability	589	6.7	6.1
Other Health Impairment	345	3.9	3.3
Other Disabilities	122	1.4	1.1
Speech/Language Impairment	153	1.7	1.9
All Disabilities	1,737	19.7	16.3

¹ This table represents students in grades K-12 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

Students with Disabilities Placed Outside of the District²

	District		State
	Count	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Public Schools in Other Districts	76	4.4	8.2
Private Schools or Other Settings	49	2.8	4.6

² This table represents students in grades K-12 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

Overall Expenditures³: 2020-21

	Total (\$)	Per Pupil	
		District (\$)	State (\$)
Instruction	\$90,056,370	\$10,126	\$12,000
Support services - students	\$9,545,962	\$1,182	\$1,468
Support services - instruction	\$407,953	\$51	\$780
Support services - general administration	\$2,130,665	\$264	\$472
Support services - school based administration	\$6,548,480	\$811	\$1,103
Central and other support services	\$4,947,404	\$613	\$703
Operation and maintenance of plant	\$13,768,732	\$1,706	\$1,910
Student transportation services	\$6,372,164	\$1,381	\$1,287
Food services	.	.	\$28
Enterprise operations	\$1,055,088	\$131	\$170
Total	\$134,832,818	\$15,160	\$19,134

³ Expenditures may be supported by local tax revenues, state grants, federal grants, municipal in-kind services, tuition and other sources.

Special Education Expenditures: 2020-21

	District		State
	Total (\$)	Percent of Total (%)	Percent of Total (%)
Teacher Salaries	\$7,539,239	23.1	29.7
Instructional Aide Salaries	\$2,373,606	7.3	10.8
Other Salaries	\$6,730,580	20.6	9.8
Employee Benefits	\$4,952,631	15.2	13.8
Purchased Services Other Than Transportation	\$604,751	1.9	5.7
Special Education Tuition	\$7,444,805	22.8	22.6
Supplies	\$96,379	0.3	0.6
Property Services	\$114,403	0.4	0.4
Purchased Services For Transportation	\$2,772,223	8.5	6.3
Equipment	\$18,180	0.1	0.2
All Other Expenditures	\$599	0.0	0.1
Total	\$32,647,397	100.0	100.0
Percent of Total Expenditures Used for Special Education		24.2	24.5

Expenditures by Revenue Source⁴: 2020-21

	Percent of Total (%) Excluding School Construction
Local	36.3
State	54.3
Federal	8.0
Tuition & Other	1.4

⁴ Revenue sources do not include state-funded Teachers' Retirement Board contributions, Connecticut Technical Education and Career System (CTECS) operations, CSDE-budgeted costs for salaries and leadership activities and other state-funded school districts (e.g., Dept. of Children and Families and Dept. of Correction).

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2021-22

Meriden School District

Performance and Accountability

District Performance Index (DPI)

A District Performance Index (DPI) is the average performance of students in a subject area (i.e., ELA, Mathematics or Science) on the state summative assessments. The DPI ranges from 0-100. A DPI is reported for all students tested in a district and for students in each individual student group. Connecticut's ultimate target for a DPI is 75.

	English Language Arts (ELA)		Math		Science	
	Count	DPI	Count	DPI	Count	DPI
American Indian or Alaska Native	*	*	*	*	0	N/A
Asian	82	72.0	82	66.0	*	*
Black or African American	451	57.3	448	48.5	205	49.9
Hispanic or Latino of any race	2,562	57.5	2,552	50.4	1,021	51.5
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	*	*	*	*	*	*
Two or More Races	169	63.7	170	54.6	52	50.0
White	1,012	69.1	1,005	61.8	450	61.0
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	888	52.8	884	48.1	331	47.9
Non-English Learners/Non-Multilingual Learners	3,394	62.8	3,379	54.7	1,428	55.4
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	3,395	58.4	3,379	51.0	1,364	51.5
Not Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	887	69.9	884	62.4	395	62.4
Students with Disabilities	785	41.5	781	35.2	323	38.7
Students without Disabilities	3,497	65.1	3,482	57.4	1,436	57.4
High Needs	3,551	58.0	3,535	50.7	1,431	51.1
Non-High Needs	731	74.1	728	66.0	328	66.3
District	4,282	60.8	4,263	53.3	1,759	54.0

National Assessment of Educational Progress (NAEP): Percent At or Above Proficient¹

	NAEP 2022		NAEP 2013
	Grade 4	Grade 8	Grade 12
READING			
Connecticut	35	35	50
National Public	32	29	36
MATH			
Connecticut	37	30	32
National Public	35	26	25

¹ NAEP is often called the "Nation's Report Card." It is sponsored by the U.S. Department of Education. This table compares Connecticut's performance to that of national public school students. Performance standards for state assessments and NAEP are set independently. Therefore, one should not expect performance results to be the same across Smarter Balanced and NAEP. Instead, NAEP results are meant to complement other state assessment data. To view performance on NAEP by student group, at https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Student-Assessment/NAEP/report-card_NAEP-2022.pdf

Physical Fitness Tests: Students Reaching Health Standard²

	Percent of Students by Grade ³ (%)				All Tested Grades	
	4	6	8	HS	Count	Rate (%)
Sit & Reach	82.8	73.8	80.0	77.6	2,547	78.5
Curl Up	75.9	76.8	82.6	76.9	2,547	78.1
Push Up	60.7	50.1	53.0	63.8	2,547	56.4
Mile Run/PACER	68.3	47.7	36.9	34.8	2,547	47.4
All Tests - District	48.8	38.5	32.1	29.9	2,547	37.6
All Tests - State	48.9	46.7	44.3	43.3		45.8

²The Connecticut Physical Fitness Assessment (CPFA) is administered to students in Grades 4, 6, 8 and High School (HS). The health-related fitness scores gathered through the CPFA should be used to educate and motivate children and their families to increase physical activity and develop lifetime fitness habits.

³Only students assessed in all four areas are included in this calculation.

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2021-22

Meriden School District

Cohort Graduation: Four-Year¹

	2020-21	
	Cohort Count ²	Rate (%)
Black or African American	73	82.2
Hispanic or Latino of any race	323	83.0
White	151	90.1
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	96	79.2
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	451	83.8
Students with Disabilities	130	61.5
District	584	85.3
State		89.6

¹ The four-year cohort graduation rate represents the percentage of first-time 9th graders who earn a standard high school diploma within four years.

² Cohort count includes all students in the cohort as of the end of the 2020-21 school year.

11th and 12th Graders Demonstrating Postsecondary Readiness³

	Participation ⁴	Meeting Benchmark	
	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Female	94.0	192	33.0
Male	90.7	133	20.5
Non-Binary	N/A	N/A	N/A
Black or African American	91.1	24	15.2
Hispanic or Latino	91.9	138	20.1
White	93.8	127	41.2
English Learners/ Multilingual Learners	85.6	12	7.8
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	91.9	210	22.4
Students with Disabilities	74.2	9	3.2
District	92.3	325	26.4
State	95.0		43.5

³Students demonstrate postsecondary readiness through at least one of the following:

- SAT® - meets benchmark score on SAT, Revised SAT or Connecticut School Day SAT
- ACT® - meets benchmark score on 3 of 4 exams (benchmark score varies by subject)
- AP® - 3 or higher on any one AP® exam
- IB® - 4 or higher on any one IB® exam
- Earning three or more non-remedial college credits cumulatively during high school.

⁴Participation Rate equals the number of test-takers in 11th and 12th grade divided by the number of students enrolled in those grades, as a percentage.

Sources:

SAT® and AP® statistics derived from data provided by the College Board.

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ACT® statistics derived from data provided by ACT, Inc.

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IB® statistics derived from data provided by the International Baccalaureate Organization.

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College Entrance and Persistence

	Class of 2021	Class of 2020
	Entrance ⁵ Rate (%)	Persistence ⁶ Rate (%)
Female	57.6	73.7
Male	45.5	65.6
Non-Binary	N/A	N/A
Black or African American	54.7	76.5
Hispanic or Latino of any race	42.0	57.1
White	64.7	79.2
English Learners/ Multilingual Learners	33.3	72.7
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	45.8	67.2
Students with Disabilities	24.3	57.7
District	51.7	70.1
State	66.1	84.9

⁵ College entrance refers to the percent of high school graduates from the year who enrolled in college any time during the first year after high school.

⁶ College persistence refers to the percent of students who enrolled in college the first year after high school and returned for a second year (Freshman to Sophomore persistence).

Source: National Student Clearinghouse

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2021-22

Meriden School District

Next Generation Accountability Results

Connecticut's Next Generation Accountability System is a broad set of 12 indicators that help tell the story of how well a district/school is preparing its students for success in college, careers, and life. It moves beyond test scores and graduation rates to provide a more holistic, multifactor perspective of district and school performance.

Indicator		Index/Rate	Target	Points Earned	Max Points	% Points Earned	State Average Index/Rate
ELA Performance Index	All Students	60.8	75	40.5	50	81.0	64.2
	High Needs Students	58.0	75	38.7	50	77.3	54.2
Math Performance Index	All Students	53.3	75	35.6	50	71.1	58.6
	High Needs Students	50.7	75	33.8	50	67.6	47.7
Science Performance Index	All Students	54.0	75	36.0	50	72.0	61.4
	High Needs Students	51.1	75	34.1	50	68.2	51.3
ELA Academic Growth	All Students	61.2%	100%	61.2	100	61.2	60.4%
	High Needs Students	59.8%	100%	59.8	100	59.8	56.2%
Math Academic Growth	All Students	61.1%	100%	61.1	100	61.1	65.2%
	High Needs Students	59.8%	100%	59.8	100	59.8	59.1%
Progress Toward English Proficiency	Literacy	57.0%	100%	28.5	50	57.0	64.9%
	Oral	51.5%	100%	25.7	50	51.5	57.4%
Chronic Absenteeism	All Students	29.1%	<=5%	1.8	50	3.5	23.7%
	High Needs Students	32.6%	<=5%	0.0	50	0.0	34.0%
Preparation for CCR	% Taking Courses	87.9%	75%	50.0	50	100.0	84.8%
	% Meeting Benchmark	26.4%	75%	17.6	50	35.2	43.5%
On-track to High School Graduation		86.2%	94%	45.8	50	91.7	82.7%
4-year Graduation All Students (2021 Cohort)		85.3%	94%	90.7	100	90.7	89.6%
6-year Graduation - High Needs Students (2019 Cohort)		83.1%	94%	88.4	100	88.4	85.2%
Postsecondary Entrance (Class of 2021)		51.7%	75%	68.9	100	68.9	66.1%
Physical Fitness (estimated part rate) and (fitness rate)		96.5% 37.6%	75%	25.1	50	50.2	94.0% 45.8%
Arts Access		60.0%	60%	50.0	50	100.0	52.4%
Accountability Index				953.1	1450	65.7	

NOTE: A dot (.) appears in the table above when there are fewer than 20 students in the student group or the indicator is not applicable based on grades served.

Gap Indicators	Non-High Needs Rate ¹	High Needs Rate	Size of Gap	State Gap Mean +1 Stdev ²	Is Gap an Outlier? ²
Achievement Gap Size Outlier?					N
ELA Performance Index Gap	74.1	58.0	16.1	16.6	
Math Performance Index Gap	66.0	50.7	15.3	18.2	
Science Performance Index Gap	66.3	51.1	15.2	17.4	
Graduation Rate Gap	94.0%	83.1%	10.9%	10.2%	Y

¹If the Non-High Needs Rate exceeds the ultimate target (75 for Performance Index and 94% for graduation rate), the ultimate target is used for gap calculations.

²If the size of the gap exceeds the state mean gap plus one standard deviation, the gap is an outlier.

NOTE: A dot (.) appears in the table above when there are fewer than 20 students in at least one of the student groups used to calculate the gap measure or the indicator is not applicable based on grades served. Gap calculations are based on unrounded rates.

Subject/Student Group		Participation Rate (%) ³
ELA	All Students	98.0
	High Needs Students	97.7
Math	All Students	97.6
	High Needs Students	97.2
Science	All Students	95.9
	High Needs Students	95.3

³Minimum participation standard is 95%.

Connecticut's State Identified Measurable Result (SIMR) for Children with Disabilities

Increase the reading performance of all 3rd grade students with disabilities statewide, as measured by Connecticut's English Language Arts (ELA) Performance Index.

Grade 3 ELA Performance Index for Students with Disabilities:

District: 46.4

State: 49.7

Supporting Resources: <https://public-edsight.ct.gov/Overview/Next-Generation-Accountability-Dashboard#related-links>

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2021-22

Meriden School District

Narratives

School District Improvement Plans and Parental Outreach Activities

The Meriden Public Schools (MPS) has eight elementary schools, three middle schools, and two high schools. More than 77% of the district's student population of 8,500 students are eligible for free or reduced-priced meals, and 75% are students of color. Implementation of our District Improvement Plan has led to promoting student-centered learning environments across the district using blended learning, leading to greater choice and voice, critical thinking, creativity, and academic gains. Restorative practices at secondary schools have increased student voice. Elementary schools are also engaged in implementing restorative practices. In our 1:1 environment, students are provided district-issued devices to use with digital content in classes and to explore anytime, anywhere, learning beyond the classroom. Students keep their devices over the summer to access digital resources. High school students can enroll in online courses during the summer as well. Students may "check out" mobile hotspots if in need of Internet access.

School improvement plans include assessments conducted regularly throughout the school year. School-based data teams analyze data to identify areas where improvement is needed and areas where significant progress has been made. While School Improvement Plans are specific to school needs, they are aligned to the District Improvement Plan's goals in Talent, Academics, Climate, and Operations.

With the adoption of Connecticut's Common Core Standards, the district has embedded these standards into the district's English Language Arts-Literacy and Mathematics curriculum and implemented the NGSS in Science and the Connecticut Elementary and Secondary Social Studies Frameworks. The District Improvement Plan was recently revised by the District Leadership Team which meets monthly to review district academic, attendance, discipline, and school climate data. The Team monitors progress, provides feedback, and makes recommendations to our central office team.

With grant funding from a foundation, Meriden has developed a visual Portrait of a Graduate which was created through an Advisory Committee which includes community members, parents, students, administrators, and teachers. The Portrait consists of five attributes: I am a Learner, I am a Thinker, I am an Advocate, I am a Collaborator, I am Prepared for life after high school. Each attribute has corresponding indicators. Currently school based teams at the high schools are constructing multiple learning experiences - in school and in the community-that will allow all students to develop these competencies and ensure access to those opportunities is equitable and available to all students.

Efforts to engage our families include our Family School Liaison Team, which works to connect families to school supports, educates families on school and district expectations, makes home visits, and fosters school-community events. Community and Parent Learning. The district recently implemented ParentSquare district-wide. ParentSquare enables users to select from 100 languages to receive messages, allows teachers to use it for class-group messaging and one-to-one communication, and allows permission slips, automatic attendance, and more. MPS has a 99.1% contact ability across the district.

Efforts to Reduce Racial, Ethnic and Economic Isolation

The Meriden Public Schools believes that education is the great equalizer and provides a path to a better life for all students. The district continues to be proactive in combating systemic racism in our schools. We embrace the richness of our diversity, value our tapestry of different colors and cultures, and remain committed to addressing racial discrimination or unconscious bias. Meriden ensures all students have access to quality educational experiences and graduate college, career and life ready. Our long-standing commitment to equity is evident in initiatives implemented during the last decade. We have generated a series of Racial Equity Awareness training modules, created an Affinity Group for educators of color and other interested teachers. Most importantly, the district has recently hired a Director of Equity and Instruction to ensure equitable opportunities and access for all learners.

Our steps include a six-pronged approach: 1). Equity Leaders are continuing to roll out racial equity awareness training modules to high school teachers in small group settings to encourage conversations about the material presented; 2). Equity Leaders are expanding racial equity awareness training to middle and high school teachers using the same protocols; 3) Equity Leaders are presenting components of racial equity awareness training modules at our Board of Education meetings, Administrators' Meetings, Elementary and Secondary Principals' Meetings, and Administrators' Retreat; 4) office of Personnel and Talent Development continues to pursue recruitment and hiring of teachers of color in collaboration with Affinity Group; 5) The Office of Research and Evaluation continues to provide central office and board of education with Student Climate Survey data and trend analyses of student perception of racism in their school and community as well as disciplinary data disaggregated by students of color; and 6) A District Sub-Committee was established to ensure the advancement of equitable learning opportunities throughout the district. Under the leadership of the Director of Equity and Inclusion, Meriden's High School Equity Leaders are training two Equity Leaders in each of our eight elementary schools and three middle schools.

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2021-22

Meriden School District

Equitable Allocation of Resources among District Schools

The Meriden Board of Education takes great care to equitably allocate resources among the district's schools and programs based on the needs of individual buildings and district initiatives and to apply an equity lens to allocations. Resources for such areas as ongoing supplies and compensation for the errors inherent in enrollment projections are maintained. The Office of Teaching and Innovation maintains an emergency account that ensures all schools have necessary materials in cases where the building budget is unable to meet needs. The size of the building determines resource allocations for custodial supplies and manpower, and the age and condition of buildings are used to determine the priority list for major improvements and repairs.